

Paper B Reading into Writing

Feedback for Week 4



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

This week you had extracts from these sources. How did you cite them?



Davis, C. J., & Lewandowsky, S. (2022). Thinking about climate change: look up and look around!. *Thinking & Reasoning*, 28(3), 321-326.

Lewandowsky, S. (2021). Climate change disinformation and how to combat it. *Annual review of public health*, 42(1), 1-21.

Maertens, R., Anseel, F., & van der Linden, S. (2020). Combatting climate change misinformation: Evidence for longevity of inoculation and consensus messaging effects. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 70, 101455.

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Davis, C. J., & Lewandowsky, S. (2022). Thinking about climate change: look up and look around!. *Thinking & Reasoning*, 28(3), 321-326. (Davis & Lewandowsky, 2022)

Lewandowsky, S. (2021). Climate change disinformation and how to combat it. *Annual review of public health*, 42(1), 1-21. (Lewandowsky, 2021)

Maertens, R., Anseel, F., & van der Linden, S. (2020). Combatting climate change misinformation: Evidence for longevity of inoculation and consensus messaging effects. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 70, 101455. (Maertens et al, 2020)

Please note:



- You do not need to write a list of references for Paper B; you only need to use in-text citations.

The question on climate change had two parts:



Why is the scientific consensus on climate change often misunderstood or ignored by the public? What can be done about this?

Discuss:

1. How did you answer the first question?
2. How did you answer the second question?
3. Did you spend an equal amount of your essay on each question?
4. How did you structure your essay?

Why is the scientific consensus on climate change often misunderstood or ignored by the public?



There were different ways you could have answered this. Did you include any of the following?

1. **Deliberate misinformation campaigns:** Powerful vested interests (e.g., fossil fuel companies, political lobbies) have funded and spread disinformation to sow doubt about the consensus and delay action.
2. **Media false balance:** Journalistic norms of presenting "both sides" have given a tiny minority of contrarian scientists a platform disproportionate to their scientific standing, creating the public illusion of a debate where none exists.
3. **Psychological and cognitive barriers:** People process information through their pre-existing worldviews and ideologies. Acknowledging the consensus may conflict with one's identity or values (e.g., economic conservatism, distrust of government).
4. **Misunderstanding of climate systems:** People mistakenly believe that reducing emissions will lead to immediate cooling, fostering a false sense that there is still time to wait and see, reducing the urgency to act on the consensus.
5. **The nature of online information:** Misinformation spreads faster and deeper online than factual information, and corrections can be ineffective or even backfire, especially when they challenge a person's worldview.

What can be done about this?

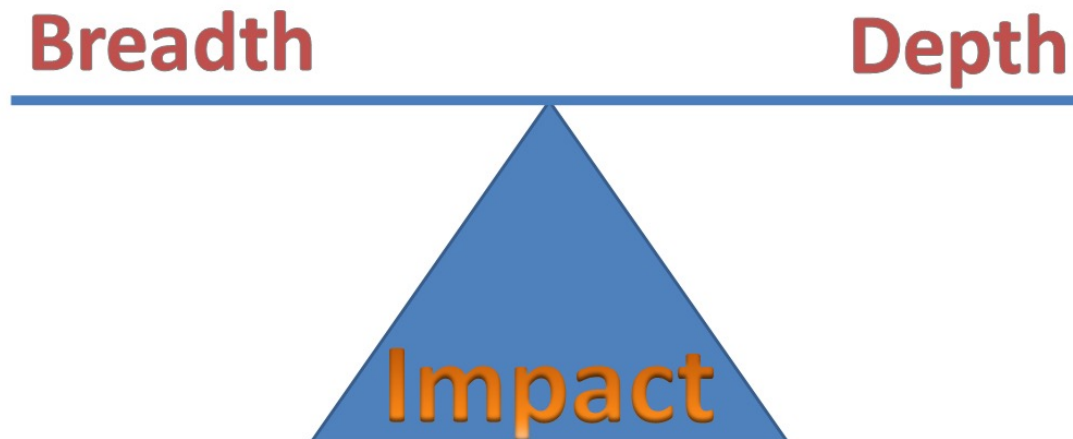


Again, there were different ways you could have answered this. Did you include any of the following?

1. **Inoculation (pre-bunking):** Proactively warn people about misleading rhetorical techniques and refute them in advance, building mental resistance to misinformation before it is encountered.
2. **Strategic framing of messages:** Move away from general climate change messaging and frame specific policies in ways that align with the audience's values (e.g., highlighting public health benefits, framing CO2 as "pollution").
3. **Improved science communication:** Move beyond the "deficit model" (just providing more facts) and design culturally resonant consensus messages.
4. **Promote collective efficacy:** Help people develop a belief in their own power and the power of collectives to bring about systemic change, countering the feeling of individual helplessness.
5. **Legal, political, and systemic action:** Address the root cause by challenging the well-funded networks that produce disinformation through transparency, litigation, and policy.

Balance

- You cannot include everything in a short essay. You need to balance breadth and depth.
- It's better to discuss 2-3 factors in detail than 5 superficially.



Possible structures



STRUCTURE A

- INTRODUCTION
- REASONS (why the scientific consensus on climate change is often misunderstood or ignored by the public)
- SOLUTIONS (what can be done about this)
- CONCLUSION

STRUCTURE B

- INTRODUCTION
- REASON ONE (why the scientific consensus on climate change is often misunderstood or ignored by the public)
- SOLUTION ONE
- REASON TWO
- SOLUTION TWO
- CONCLUSION

Possible structures



STRUCTURE A

- INTRODUCTION
- REASONS
- SOLUTIONS
- CONCLUSION

STRUCTURE B

- INTRODUCTION
- REASON ONE
- SOLUTION ONE
- REASON TWO
- SOLUTION TWO
- CONCLUSION

Which structure most closely resembles your essay? Why did you choose that structure? Would the other structure have worked?

Enriching your vocabulary



- A good way to improve your vocabulary is through collocations.
- **Collocation:** “A word or phrase that is often used with another word or phrase, in a way that sounds correct...” - Cambridge Dictionary
- Can you think of a collocation for the words below:
 1. Climate _____
 2. Greenhouse _____
 3. Carbon _____
 4. Renewable _____
 5. To raise _____
 6. To take _____
 7. To cut _____

Possible collocations:

1. Climate **change** / catastrophe / emergency...
2. Greenhouse **gas** / gases / emissions...
3. Carbon **emissions** / tax / footprint....
4. Renewable **energy** / sources...
5. To raise **awareness** / concerns / the alarm...
6. To take **action** / steps / the lead...
7. To cut **emissions**...

Collocations

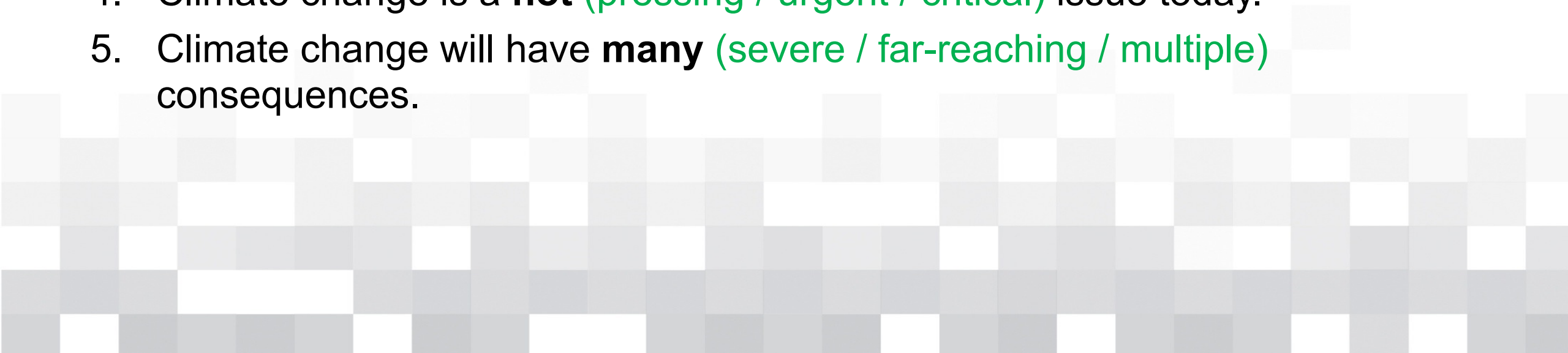


Use the links below to find alternatives for the words in black.

- www.ozdic.com
- <http://flax.nzdl.org/greenstone3/flax?a=fp&sa=collAbout&c=collocations>
- <http://www.just-the-word.com/>

1. Climate change is a **big** problem.
2. There is a lot of **wrong** information about climate change.
3. We need a **good** solution to climate change.
4. Climate change is a **hot** issue today.
5. Climate change will have **many** consequences.

For example:

1. Climate change is a **big** (acute / serious / severe...) problem.
 2. There is a lot of **wrong** (false / incorrect / inaccurate...) information about climate change.
 3. We need a **good** (feasible / viable / effective) solution to climate change.
 4. Climate change is a **hot** (pressing / urgent / critical) issue today.
 5. Climate change will have **many** (severe / far-reaching / multiple) consequences.
- 
- A decorative graphic at the bottom of the slide consisting of a grid of squares in various shades of gray, creating a checkerboard-like effect.

Identify collocations in this paragraph



The scientific consensus on climate change is often misunderstood due to a deliberate disinformation campaign orchestrated by vested interests. As revealed through leaks and lawsuits, fossil fuel companies have deliberately spread climate disinformation for decades, employing rhetorical strategies designed to sow doubt about the scientific consensus (Lewandowsky, 2021). This is achieved through techniques such as using fake expert accounts and promoting pseudoscientific alternatives (Maertens et al., 2020). Furthermore, the media has historically exacerbated the problem through false-balance coverage, giving a handful of contrarian voices a platform disproportionate to their scientific standing. This creates the public impression of an ongoing scientific debate where none exists, which reduces the public's perception of the overwhelming agreement among experts (Lewandowsky, 2021).

Suggestions (note: there are many possibilities)



The **scientific consensus** on **climate change** is often misunderstood due to a deliberate disinformation campaign orchestrated by **vested interests**. As revealed through leaks and lawsuits, fossil fuel companies have deliberately **spread climate disinformation** for decades, employing rhetorical strategies designed **to sow doubt about** the scientific consensus (Lewandowsky, 2021). This is achieved through techniques such as using fake expert accounts and promoting pseudoscientific alternatives (Maertens et al., 2020). Furthermore, the media has historically **exacerbated the problem** through false-balance coverage, giving a handful of contrarian voices a platform disproportionate to their scientific standing. This creates the public impression of an **ongoing scientific debate** where none exists, which reduces the public's perception of the **overwhelming agreement** among experts (Lewandowsky, 2021).

Identify collocations in this paragraph



Compounding this deluge of misinformation are significant cognitive and ideological barriers. For many, acknowledging the anthropogenic cause of climate change implies the need for radical changes that may conflict with their value system and worldview, leading to motivated reasoning (Davis & Lewandowsky, 2022). This is compounded by a critical challenge of human cognition: people systematically underappreciate the implications of carbon emissions, mistakenly believing that reducing emissions will lead to immediate results. This fosters a false sense that there is plenty of time to act, reducing the urgency to respond to the impending threat (Lewandowsky, 2021). Consequently, the science-public disconnect is not merely an information gap but a result of how information is processed through pre-existing cultural and ideological lenses.

Suggestions (note: there are many possibilities)



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Identify collocations in this paragraph



To combat this pervasive misinformation and bridge the ideological divide, a multi-faceted approach is required. Moving beyond the ineffective deficit model of simply providing more facts, a more effective solution involves strategic framing. This means framing climate policies to highlight co-benefits, such as public health improvements from cutting emissions, which can increase policy support across political divides (Lewandowsky, 2021). More proactively, inoculation theory offers a promising method to build up resistance by forewarning people about misleading arguments and providing evidence to counter misinformation before it is encountered (Maertens et al., 2020). Ultimately, fostering a sense of collective efficacy—a belief in the power of collective action—is essential to mount a truly global response to this global crisis and drive the rapid reduction in emissions and transition to renewable energy that is urgently needed (Davis & Lewandowsky, 2022)

Suggestions (note: there are many possibilities)



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Your turn



Look through your essay and find some collocations to improve.



Reading into Writing Feedback Workbook



- Look at the feedback from your teacher.
- Do the Week 4 exercises in “Reading into Writing AI Feedback Workbook” for additional feedback.
- Complete the cumulative progress tracker and end-of-course reflection in the workbook. Be prepared to discuss these in your tutorial on Friday.

Discuss: looking backward and forward



- You have now had feedback on four essays. What patterns of language error were identified each week?
- Have you continued to make the same type of errors? If so, what can you do to avoid those errors in the future?
- What are your aims for your practice assessment and final assessment? What areas do you want to improve?



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DigiExam

[Department Name] ■

- As a reminder, we will be using Digiexam for practice Paper A and practice Paper B.
- You saw the instructions for installing Digiexam during the Information Session.
- If you are having problems, please go to the Tech Centre on the 1st floor of the library: Monday to Friday: 09:00 - 19:00; Saturday: 11:00 - 18:00.
- If you still have problems, please email Alison: A.Standring@lse.ac.uk

- You can find more information about e-Exams on this website: [e-Exams](#)
- Please note: your device must be a laptop or a tablet device with an [integrated keyboard](#). Tablet devices without an integrated keyboard are not suitable (this includes some Chromebooks and some Microsoft Surface laptops). ***Your laptop must have a USB or USB-C port***

A few more things to note:



- **Eduroam** is the **recommended** wi-fi network (LSE email and regular password), make sure that you have this as a saved network before entering the exam room. Guidance on how to connect to **eduroam** can be found on [this webpage](#).
- To reduce the risk of background applications interfering with Digiexam, apply settings on [this webpage](#) before all of your e-Exams.
- Connectivity issues during an exam may occasionally require an e-Exam Support Assistant to use a USB drive to unlock your attempt on Digiexam, or allow you to submit your work. Apply the settings on [this webpage](#) to minimise the chances of further complications during this process.



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INSTALLING DIGIEXAM

Please note: Digiexam has decided to extend the use of the old version (Legacy) of the application for the Spring/Summer and IRDAP 2025 exam periods. Please use this and not the new version.

New app logo



Legacy app logo



myapps.microsoft.com

1) Visit [MyApps](#).

You may need to complete [Multi-Factor Authentication](#) (MFA).

2) Click on the LSE e-Exams /Digiexam icon.



3) Log on using single sign-in and LSE credentials.

4) On the webpage that appears, click on the link on the word [here](#) in the top right of the screen.

Start new exam

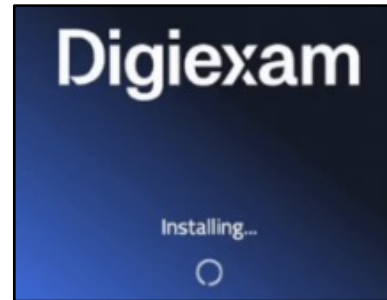
To start a new exam, open the **Digiexam** app on your computer. You can download and install the app [here](#).

[Open Digiexam app](#)

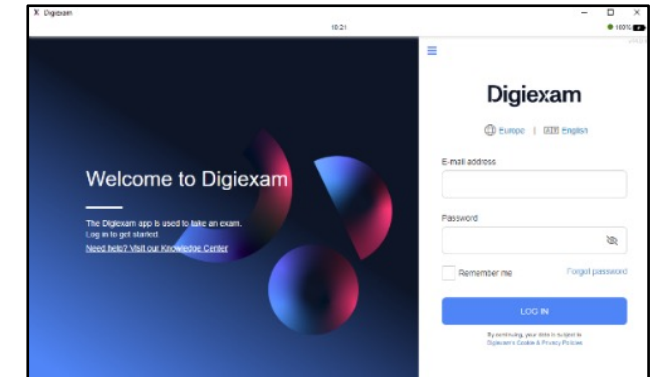
5) Select the relevant download option for your device.

6) Follow the instructions that appear to download Digiexam.

7) Wait for Digiexam to fully download and install.



8) Once downloaded, **do not** try to log on through this screen that appears.



You have successfully downloaded Digiexam!



Setting up your account and downloading the app to your device is an **essential** step before entering an LSE exam room. You will not be given additional time or support to set up the app in an exam room.

3 step access to your Digixam account

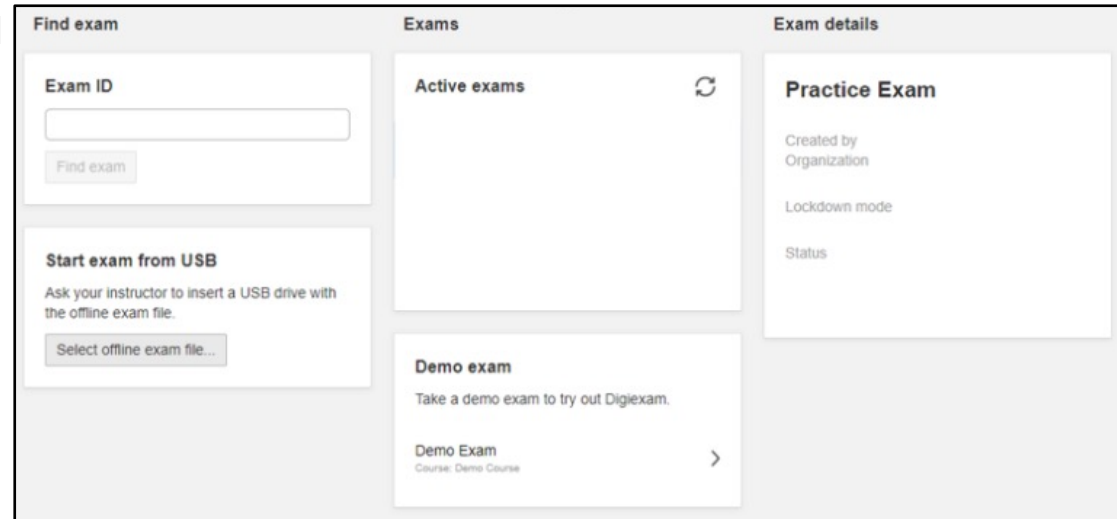
1) Go to the [MyApps](#) webpage and click on the Digixam icon. The Digixam webpage will open.

★ Save this webpage as a bookmark.

2) Click on **Open Digixam app** in the top right corner of the webpage.

Open Digixam app

3) The Digixam app will open, and you will be logged in automatically.



The screenshot displays the Digixam app interface with three main sections:

- Find exam:** Includes an "Exam ID" input field, a "Find exam" button, and a "Start exam from USB" section with instructions to insert a USB drive and a "Select offline exam file..." button.
- Exams:** Contains an "Active exams" section with a refresh icon and a "Demo exam" section with the text "Take a demo exam to try out Digixam." and a "Demo Exam" link for "Course: Demo Course".
- Exam details:** Features a "Practice Exam" section with fields for "Created by", "Organization", "Lockdown mode", and "Status".

Any problems?



- Read the information about e-Exams on this website: [e-Exams](#)
- Let your teacher know!
- Visit the Tech Centre on the first floor of the library
- Email Alison: A.Standring@lse.ac.uk